CRICMASTER ULTRA · ADMIN GUIDE

Franchise Auction

The admin's guide: setting one up, running the room, and getting the squads into a league.

Who this is for — bot admins and **auction admins** (appointed with `/aadminadd`, able to run every auction command and no other admin command in the bot). Owners and co-owners want the player guide; everything in it still applies to you.

What is in here

- The one-page running order, start to finish
- The setup page, fold by fold
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- The franchise field — and it as a JSON file
- Building the pool, and ordering the sets
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- Focus mode: the group locked to auction commands
- The opening purse, direct bids, and one bidder per franchise
- Retention, Right To Match and expansion picks
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- Finishing: publishing, cloning, cancelling
- Troubleshooting, and the mistakes that are recoverable
- Every admin command, grouped

Every number in this guide is the shipped default. All of them are set per auction, and `/arules` in the auction's group prints what this one actually uses.

1. The running order

Everything below expands on this. If you have run a draft, the shape is familiar: the event is bound to one group, the commands refuse anywhere else, and the admin gate answers whoever typed it rather than pretending the command does not exist.

```
In the auction's group:
   /anew Season 2            create it, bound to this group

On the website  (Admin → Tournament Panel →  Franchise Auctions):
   ⚙  Settings        purse, seconds per lot, anti-snipe
     Squad rules      squad size, overseas, role min/max
     Base prices      one price per rating range
     Franchises       name, owner id, co-owners, purse
     Auction pool     build the pool, order the sets

Back in the group, if the auction uses them:
   /artmset 2 45 200         Right To Match rules
   /aretain Mumbai | Virat Kohli | 18
   /aretlock on              close the retention window
   /apickset 3               expansion picks, if any

Then:
   /atimer 60 40 20 10 5     open 60s · bid under 40s → 40s
                             · warnings 20s & 10s · count 5
   /adirect off              (optional) ladder only, no typed bids
   /acall Auction starts in 10 minutes
   /astart

At the end:
   /apublish                 squads → a Challenge League
   /aclone Season 3          next season, same rules and field
```

The reference card is always one command away: `/auction` (or `/adminhelp`) prints every admin command, section by section, in the group or in your DM.

2. Creating one, and binding it to a group

`/anew Season 2` creates an auction **and** binds it to the group you typed it in. `/abind Season 2` binds an existing one, which is how you move an auction created on the website into its room.

- One group holds **one** auction: two would make every command in that room ambiguous.
- A group whose last auction is **finished or cancelled** is free — binding a new season to it releases the old one and says so in the room. A **running** auction keeps its group.
- An auction with no group cannot start: `/astart` says so.

Before it opens, every read-only view already answers — and answers in a DM. Owners do their homework against `/arules`, `/asets` and `/apurse` the night before, which is the point of setting the numbers early.

3. The setup page, fold by fold

The page is a dozen rule-sets deep and a visit touches one or two of them, so each is a **closed fold with its live numbers in the summary** — the status, the purse, how many franchises, what the role rule says — and a strip at the top reads the whole auction back without opening anything.

Fold	What it holds
⚙ Settings	Name, the group chat id, seconds per lot, the opening purse (which moves every franchise — see below), the three anti-snipe numbers, and the focus-mode and direct-bid switches.
Squad rules	Squad minimum and maximum, the home country and the overseas cap, and a minimum and maximum for each of the four roles.
Base prices	A list of rating ranges, one price each, with Add range.
Franchises	One fold per franchise: name, city, logo, owner and co-owners, and its purse. Delete asks for the name back.
The field, as a file	Download the franchises as JSON, and upload one back.
Auction pool	The set queue, the two set builders and the catalogue filter.
Console	The live auction, driven with buttons.

4. Base prices by rating range

A row reads top first, the way the room says it: **96 down to 92 → ₹2 Cr**. The highest band's top is left blank, meaning “and up” — every ladder needs one of those, or its best cards fall through to the floor.

- **Overlaps are settled by the dearer band** (the first band a rating fits wins), rather than refused: an overlap is somebody narrowing a rung.
- **Gaps are named on save**, because a gap is silent — those cards would simply be built at the floor and nobody would find out until the pool was priced.
- **The price is stamped onto the lot when the lot is built**, not looked up when it opens. Editing the ladder afterwards cannot move a price a lot already went on the block at, and cannot move one mid-auction.
- One player can be overridden from the pool table, while the lot is still queued.

`/arules` prints the same ladder to the room, band by band.

5. Squad rules and the two ends of the role rule

Both ends are saved together, because they constrain each other: a minimum above its own maximum, or minimums adding up past the squad limit, describes a squad nobody could ever finish. That is refused on the page rather than half-way through a live lot.

```
min / max squad      how many players a squad may hold
home country         anybody else counts as overseas
max overseas         the cap on those
role min / max       per role: Batsman, Bowler,
                     All-rounder, Wicket Keeper
```

They are enforced differently, and they have to be. A **maximum** is a fact about the squad in front of you, so a bid that would break it is refused on a plain count. A **minimum** is a promise about a squad that does not exist yet, so it is enforced as **reachability**: refused while there is still a slot to fix the problem with, never afterwards. Leave a role blank for "no rule"; a typed `0` maximum is a real rule ("no specialist keepers here").

Owners see the whole thing in `/arules`, and the board prints each franchise's max bid, so nobody meets one of these rules for the first time by being refused by it.

6. The franchise field

Name, city, logo, owner and co-owners, and a purse that defaults to the season's. The owner is a **Telegram id, not an account in the bot**: an admin builds the field from a list, and some of those people have never messaged the bot. Owner and co-owners are equals for every check `/bid` makes.

- `/aco Mumbai | 123456789` adds a co-owner from the group.
- `/acall [message]` tags every owner and co-owner — the ten-minute warning.
- `/aremoveteam Delhi` previews; `/aremoveteam Delhi | confirm` does it. Its players go back into the pool and its opening purse is shared equally between the rest.
- **⬇ Download franchises (JSON)** and the upload beside it are for building a field of ten offline, or copying one between seasons.

A franchise with no owner id cannot bid, and `/astart` refuses to open an auction that has one — by name, rather than letting the room find out on the first lot.

7. Building the pool, and the order it runs in

One card holds the set queue, the two set builders and the catalogue filter: filter by name, rating band, country, role, batting hand, bowling style and card edition, preview, then add the ticked players or everything the filter matches. Career cards and inactive rows are excluded before you see them.

Adding is idempotent per player. Re-running the builder with a corrected filter adds what is new and leaves what is already there exactly as it is, including anything already sold — a pool builder you cannot safely run twice is one nobody dares run once.

```
/apool 85-90 | Marquee    add every card in a rating band as a set
/anextset Marquee         make a set (or a band) come next
/asetorder A, B, C        order the whole queue by set
/asets                    every set and where it stands
/awithdraw <player>       pull somebody out of the auction
```

The numbers `/asets` shows are the order the sets run in, and the website's Sets card does the same with ↑ / ↓. Ordering the queue never touches the lot on the block.

8. Focus mode: the group locked to auction commands

While an auction bound to a group is **live or paused**, that group answers auction commands and **nothing else**. Everything else is refused with one line naming where it still works, which is a DM with the bot. It is **on by default**.

```
/afocus            is it on, and what that means
/afocus off        this group behaves normally again
/afocus on         lock it back
```

The switch also lives in ⚙ Settings on the setup page, and the fold's summary says which way it is set. It is carried into a cloned season: a room that turned the lock off meant that about the room, not about one season.

What is locked	A command, or a button, in the auction's own group, while the auction is live or paused.
What is never locked	Talking. DMs. Every other group. An auction still in setup. Bot admins and auction admins — you keep every command you had.
What owners see	One line: which auction is on the block, which commands still work, and that everything else works in a DM.
Why	A thirty-second clock and a pinned board being edited every two seconds cannot share a room with a /claim card, and a bid that scrolls past unseen is how a price gets disputed.

It is announced when you change it, because it changes what every command in the group does and a room that finds out by being refused has been told the hard way.

9. Four rules worth knowing before you start

Changing the opening purse changes every franchise

It is not just the default for the next side you add. Save a new opening purse in ⚙ Settings and **every franchise moves to it**: its total is set, its remaining moves by the same amount, and the move is written into the ledger as a correction, so the purse and its ledger still agree afterwards.

- **Spending stays spent.** A side that has bought ₹30 Cr of players out of ₹100 Cr lands on ₹90 Cr of a ₹120 Cr purse.
- **A cut that would overdraw somebody is refused by name**, before anything is written — sell somebody first, or set that one franchise's own purse on its row.
- The flash message says how many franchises moved.
- **Saving the same number does nothing**, so a franchise you deliberately gave a purse of its own on its row keeps it until the season's purse actually changes.

Direct bids: the room's choice, not the rule's

```
/adirect           is it on, and what that means
/adirect off       ladder only: bare /bid and the buttons
/adirect on        a bidder may type their own number
```

A jump bid (`/bid 12` when the minimum is ₹2.4 Cr) is half of what an auction is, and a strict ladder is the other half — neither is wrong, so it is a switch rather than a rule. Off, a typed amount is refused with the number it **would** have been, and bare `/bid`, the board's buttons and your own console bid all keep working. It is on by default, carried into a cloned season, and printed in `/arules` when it is off.

One pair of hands per franchise, per lot

Whoever bids first for a franchise holds that lot; another owner or co-owner of the same side is refused, by the holder's name, until the next lot. Two of them bidding one player is one franchise raising its own price. The claim resets with the lot, and an undone bid releases it — and **your console bid is exempt**, because that is you acting for the franchise, announced as such.

Every card belongs to whoever asked for it

Each card a command posts carries a **Close** button, and only the person who asked for it can press it. That includes **your own answers**: “A lot now runs for 45s” is one more message on top of the board once the room has read it, so every admin command closes the same way — the settings and running commands, `/anew`, `/abind`, `/acall`, the `/adminhelp` card and the auction-admin commands.

The `/ainfo` menu and the Sets card go further: they answer the person who sent the command alone, because both re-render under whoever presses and a second pair of hands on one genuinely fights the first.

- **The pinned board is the exception on both counts**: its quick-bid and RTM buttons belong to the room, and it has no Close — a board any passer-by could delete is a board the auction loses mid-lot. Delete it from Telegram if you must.
- **A refusal is not a card.** One-line corrections (“only auction admins…”) carry no button: one under every error is the clutter this exists to reduce.
- **Nor is a pending retention offer.** It already carries the two answers that resolve it, and `/aretcancel` withdraws it — closing the card would hide an offer that is still open.

10. Running the room

Command	What it does
`/astart`	Open the auction, or resume a paused one. Refuses anything that would strand it halfway: no group, no franchises, an ownerless franchise, an empty pool, somebody under the retention minimum.
`/apause · /aresume`	Stop and restart the clock. A resumed lot gets a full clock, not the fraction that was left — nobody was watching a frozen countdown.
`/anext`	Put the next lot on the block.
`/aextend [seconds]`	Add time. Does not spend an anti-snipe extension — a dropped connection is not a snipe.
`/asold`	Sell at the standing bid.
`/aunsold`	Pass the lot. Refused while a bid stands.
`/aundobid`	Void the standing bid and fall back to the one under it.
`/awithdraw <player>`	Pull a player out of the auction.
`/atimer 60 40 20 10 5`	The staged clock: open with 60s; a bid with under 40s left resets to 40s; 1st warning at 20s, 2nd at 10s; the last 5 counted down, then SOLD. …10 off = no count · /atimer 45 = classic · bare reads it back.
`/asnipe <w> <e> <max>`	Anti-snipe. Setting the window equal to the extension gives the rule most rooms want: any bid in the last N seconds gives everybody N more.
`/aaccel [go]`	Re-list everything unsold now.
`/aaccelmode on|off`	The automatic ⚡ Accelerated round.

Nothing you type announces itself directly. Every command writes one event and commits; a sweeper drains that log every two seconds and says it out loud. That is why the website can drive the same auction — “Mark Sold” in the browser and `/asold` in the group are literally the same function call, and the room's message order is the same either way.

The web console

Console is the same auction driven with buttons: start, pause, next player, extend, mark sold, mark unsold, undo the last bid, withdraw — and a **bid-for-a-franchise** form for an owner whose phone has died. That last one is stamped as an admin's bid and announced as one: a bid that reads as the owner's own choice when it was not is how a result gets disputed. The countdown ticks client-side and the panel refreshes itself every two seconds.

11. Retention, RTM and expansion picks

Retention — before the first lot

```
/aretain Mumbai | Virat Kohli | 18   offer it (they must accept)
/aretainforce Mumbai | Virat Kohli   retain at once, no Accept
/aoffers                             offers still waiting
/aretcancel <player>                 withdraw a waiting offer
/aunretain <player>                  release one into the pool
/arelease <player>                   (owners) release their own
/aretlock on                         close the window
```

`/aretain` **offers** a retention: the franchise's owner or a co-owner presses Accept, and only then is the player kept. Nobody else can press it — not another owner, not you. `/aretainforce` is the instant path, for an owner who agreed in person. A retained player is an ordinary sold lot, so it counts against every cap and reaches the published league with no special handling. The spend comes off the top of the purse; the ladder pre-fills the price and the caps are what refuse. Opening the auction closes the retention window for you.

Right To Match

```
/artmset 2 45 200     2 cards each, 45s to answer, +₹2 Cr premium
/artmset off          turn it off
/artmcards Mumbai 3   one franchise's own card count
/artmforce yes|no|stand   answer an open window for a franchise
/artmundo <player>    undo a match — money and card both back
```

Three windows on one clock: the holder is asked first, the top bidder then gets one last raise, and the match is against that final number. Each window times out to the safe answer — decline, stand, decline — so a silent owner can never wedge the auction, and `/artmforce` is for when you need to answer for somebody who is not there.

Expansion picks

```
/apickset 3                       deal 3 picks to each new side
/apick Lucknow | Rahul | 12       a new side signs a player
/apickskip                        burn the turn on the clock
/apickundo                        roll the last pick back
/apicks                           the order, and whose turn
```

A side joining a league that already exists has no previous squad, so it retains nobody; picks are how it signs a few players before the auction opens. A skipped turn is a spent turn, or the order never moves on. `/apicks` is the room's readout, not yours alone — it is the new side's turn coming up.

12. Money, and the ledger behind it

```
/apurse                    every purse, max bid, squad count
/agrant Mumbai | 5         add ₹5 Cr
/agrant Mumbai | -2        take ₹2 Cr back
```

- **A bid moves no money.** The purse is debited exactly once, when a lot sells. Losing bids are kept as history — that is where a price's story lives.
- **Every movement is a ledger row**, and the purse column is a cache over it. The setup page shows any drift and a **Reconcile purses** button; a repair is written as a correction row rather than by overwriting the column, so the evidence survives.

- `/agrant` is the honest way to fix a mistake: it is recorded as an admin correction, with your id on it.

13. Finishing

```
/apublish            squads → one Challenge League
/aclone Season 3     next season: every rule, every franchise
/acancel             cancel the auction
```

- `/apublish` writes one team per franchise and one squad row per bought player. **Publishing again re-syncs the same league** rather than creating a second one, so a correction is simply republished.
- Everything downstream — the matches, the XI picker, the points table, the playoff bracket — is code that already existed and neither knows nor cares that an auction produced the squads.
- `/aclone` carries every rule and every franchise with its owners. It does **not** carry the pool (retain first, then build) or the bound group (bind the new season when the old one is done).
- **Short squads are topped up for free** at the end, from whoever is still unsold, inside the squad and overseas caps — but only after the unsold players have had their accelerated round.

13a. Trades

```
/atradewindow on|off      every trade window at once
/atraderules mid off      pre · mid · post · season · approval ·
                          cash · players 3 · trades 2 · maxcash 10
/atradedeadline 12        mid-season: after 12 league matches
/atradeapprove 7          bot admin: sign trade #7 off
/atradeveto 7 lopsided    bot admin: stop it
/atradeundo 7             bot admin: reverse it exactly
```

- **Only the bot owner / a bot admin approves.** With approval on (the default) an agreed trade waits; the bot DMs every bot admin the card with Approve / Veto, and the setup page's Trades fold lists it too.
- A mid-auction trade is refused while either side holds the standing bid or is answering a Right To Match, and the board's purses and max bids update the moment it goes through.
- A mid-season trade moves the player's league row, so his tournament stats go with him, and is refused while either team is mid-match.
- The Trades fold can also put a trade through directly — every squad rule still applies, the window does not.

14. Troubleshooting

“/astart says the pool is empty.”	Nothing is queued. Build the pool on the setup page, or /apool a rating band.
“It names franchises with no owner.”	A franchise nobody can bid for would sit out the whole auction and end with no squad. Add owner Telegram ids, then start.
“This group is already running another auction.”	One group, one auction. Finish or cancel the old one — a finished one is released automatically when you bind the next.
“Somebody's /claim is being refused in the group.”	Focus mode, working as intended. /afocus reads it back; /afocus off turns it off for this auction.
“I sold a lot to the wrong franchise.”	Undo the sale from the console, or /aundobid before it sells. The money and the squad slot both come back.
“An owner is offline and an RTM window is open.”	/artmforce yes|no|stand answers for them; it is recorded as an admin's answer. Left alone, the window times out to the safe answer anyway.
“An owner's phone has died mid-lot.”	Bid for them from the console's bid-for-a-franchise form. It is announced as an admin's bid, deliberately.
“I changed the opening purse and nothing happened.”	It moves every franchise now, and the flash says how many. If one refused, the message names the side that has already spent more than the new purse.
“Two co-owners keep outbidding each other.”	They cannot any more: the first to bid for a side holds that lot. Section 9.
“The room is jump-bidding wildly.”	/adirect off — every raise becomes one step. Bare /bid and the board's buttons still work.
“A purse looks wrong.”	Reconcile purses on the setup page re-sums the ledger and reports the drift; /agrant is the recorded way to correct one.
“The base price on a lot is wrong.”	Override that one player from the pool table while the lot is still queued. Editing the ladder cannot move a price a lot already carries.

15. Auction admins

A bot admin can appoint somebody who may run **every auction command and no other admin command in the bot** — the person who runs your league's auction does not need the keys to everything else.

```
/aadminadd <id | @user | reply>      let somebody run auctions
/aadminremove <id | @user | reply>   take it away again
/aadmins                             everyone who may run one
```

Those three are bot-admin only. Auction admins are also exempt from focus mode, like you.

16. The admin command list

Group	Commands
Setting up	/anew · /abind · /atimer · /asnipe · /afocus · /adirect · /aco · /aaccelmode
Pool & sets	/apool · /anextset · /asetorder · /asets · /awithdraw
Running it	/astart · /apause · /aresume · /anext · /aextend · /asold · /aunsold · /aundobid · /aaccel
Money	/agrant
Retention	/aretain · /aretainforce · /aoffers · /aretcancel · /aunretain · /aretlock on
Right To Match	/artmset · /artmcards · /artmforce · /artmundo
Expansion picks	/apick · /apickset · /apickskip · /apickundo
Teams	/acall · /aremoveteam
Trades	/atradewindow · /atraderules · /atradedeadline · /atradehelp
The end	/apublish · /aclone · /acancel
Bot admins only	/aadminadd · /aadminremove · /aadmins · /atradeapprove · /atradeveto · /atradeundo
The card itself	/auction · /adminhelp

`/auction` prints this list live, with a line on each command, and it is the version that cannot fall out of date.